Customer Guide: Releasing Empty Hopper Wagons from Private Sidings

Thanarak Rail Logistics Co., Ltd. (TRL), Kaeng Khoi, Saraburi · Ref. TRL-OPS-G07, version 3.1 · Issued 15 September 2026 · Effective 1 October 2026

1. Purpose and scope

This guide explains, step by step, how customers with a private siding return empty TRL covered hopper wagons after unloading. It applies to the four private-siding areas served by TRL's daily trip trains: Kaeng Khoi (sidings K1 to K6), Ban Phachi (sidings P1 to P3), Tha Lan (siding T1) and Sikhio (sidings S1 and S2). It covers two wagon classes:

- **THC-40**: 40-tonne covered hopper used for bulk cement, grain and fertiliser.
- **THC-55**: 55-tonne pressure-discharge hopper used for plastic pellets and fine powders.

Version 3.1 replaces version 3.0 of 2 February 2026. The main changes are a shorter free time for THC-55 wagons, a new 14:00 cut-off for release notices and the move of all release notices to the SidingLink portal. Paper release forms (form TRL-F12) are no longer accepted from 1 October 2026, except during a portal outage (see section 4.3).

2. Key terms

- **Placement time**: the time TRL's shunting crew records a wagon as placed on your siding. It is shown on the placement slip and in SidingLink.
- **Free time**: the period after placement during which you may unload and release a wagon without charge. For THC-40 wagons the free time is 48 hours. For THC-55 wagons it is 36 hours from 1 October 2026; until 30 September 2026 it was 72 hours.
- **Release time**: the time a valid release notice is submitted in SidingLink. This stops the detention clock, provided the wagon then passes inspection.
- **Detention charge**: the charge for each started 24-hour period that a wagon stays on your siding after its free time has ended. The rate is 1,200 baht per wagon per period for THC-40 and 1,500 baht per wagon per period for THC-55, excluding VAT.
- **Release tag**: the green numbered tag (TRL-T4) fixed to the discharge outlet lever of an empty wagon to show that it is closed and ready to move. Red tags (TRL-T5) mark wagons that must not be moved.

> **Note.** Free time runs continuously, including weekends and public holidays. It is not paused while your own unloading equipment is out of service.

3. Preparing the wagon for release

Your siding supervisor (the person named as "siding supervisor" in your siding agreement) must make sure each wagon is prepared as follows before a release notice is sent.

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1. Discharge the load completely. Tap the hopper sides with a rubber mallet to free material stuck to the slopes. No more than 50 kg of residue may remain in a THC-40 wagon and no more than 20 kg in a THC-55 wagon.
2. Close all bottom discharge gates and lock each gate lever with its pin. On THC-55 wagons, also close the air inlet valve and vent the hopper until the pressure gauge reads zero.
3. Close and latch all top loading hatches, remove any customer covers, and clear tools and chocks from the track.
4. Release the wagon's hand brake, unless your siding agreement requires it to stay applied on a gradient.
5. Fix a green release tag to the outlet lever and write the wagon number and the time on it.

If a wagon cannot be prepared, for example because a gate is jammed or a hatch is bent, do not try to force it. Fix a red tag and report it as described in section 6.

4. Submitting the release notice in SidingLink

4.1 Steps in the portal

1. Log in to SidingLink with your company account. Each customer has up to five user accounts.
2. Open "Wagons on siding", which shows each wagon's placement time and the end of its free time.
3. Select the wagons to release. You may release up to 12 wagons in one notice. For more wagons, send a second notice.
4. For each wagon, enter the release tag number and confirm the three checks on screen (gates locked, hatches closed, residue within the limit).
5. Submit. SidingLink issues a release number beginning with "RN-" and sends a confirmation e-mail to the siding supervisor. Keep the release number for any later query.

4.2 Cut-off and collection

Release notices submitted by 14:00 are collected by the next morning's trip train, which normally reaches the sidings between 06:00 and 10:00. Notices submitted after 14:00 are collected by the trip train of the following day. Trip trains run every day at Kaeng Khoi, Ban Phachi and Tha Lan. At Sikhio there is no trip train on Sundays and public holidays, so wagons released there after 14:00 on a Saturday are collected on Monday (or on the next working day after a holiday).

The detention clock stops at the release time, not at the time of collection. A late collection by TRL therefore does not increase your charges.

4.3 Portal outage

If SidingLink is unavailable for more than 30 minutes, telephone TRL Control and e-mail a paper form TRL-F12 to control@thanarak-rail.co.th. The release time is the time the e-mail is received.

5. Inspection on collection

Before coupling, the TRL train crew inspects each released wagon. The inspection procedure and the training of train crews are the responsibility of Ratchanee Boonmak, Wagon Inspection Supervisor. Each wagon receives one of three results, which are entered in SidingLink within 4 hours of the inspection:

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- **Accepted**: the wagon is collected and the detention clock is closed at the release time.
- **Accepted with remark**: the wagon is collected, but a minor fault (for example a missing gate pin or a residue level close to the limit) is recorded. No charge is made for a first remark. A second remark on the same siding within 30 days is charged as a rejection.
- **Rejected**: the wagon is left on the siding and a red tag is fixed. The release notice is cancelled and the detention clock keeps running as if no release had been made, until a new valid release. You must correct the fault and submit a new release notice. A cleaning fee of 3,500 baht per wagon is also charged if the wagon was rejected for excess residue and TRL's contractor cleans it at the depot instead.

If you disagree with a rejection, you may lodge a dispute in SidingLink under "Inspection results" within 3 working days of the inspection. Attach photographs of the wagon taken before collection. Disputes are decided by Kittipong Rakthai, Siding Operations Manager, who replies within 5 working days. If the dispute is upheld, the rejection, any cleaning fee and any extra detention charges are cancelled.

6. Damaged wagons and incidents

If a wagon is damaged on your siding, or you find damage that was already present at placement, the siding supervisor must report it to TRL Control at Kaeng Khoi (036 318 400, 24 hours) by telephone within 2 hours of discovery, and record it in SidingLink under "Report a defect". Fix a red tag and do not move the wagon with your own shunting equipment. TRL's wagon technician will assess the wagon, normally within 24 hours.

The detention clock is suspended from the time of the report until the technician's assessment. If the damage was caused by the customer, repair costs are charged at the rates in Annex B of your siding agreement and the detention clock resumes from the assessment. If the damage was already present at placement or was caused by TRL, no detention charge is made for the wagon.

7. Charges and billing

Detention charges are invoiced monthly by TRL Customer Billing, led by Wanchai Duangdee, with an itemised list of wagons and periods. Invoices are issued on the fifth working day of the following month and are payable within 30 days.

Detention charges are waived or reduced in the following cases:

- TRL placed a wagon without the 12-hour advance placement notice required by your siding agreement. Free time then starts at 06:00 on the day after placement.
- Access to the siding was closed by flooding or by an order of a public authority. The clock is suspended for the period of closure, which TRL Control records in SidingLink.

A shortage of trucks, staff or storage capacity at your own plant is not a reason to waive charges. Questions about an invoice must be sent to billing@thanarak-rail.co.th within 15 days of the invoice date; after that the invoice is treated as accepted.

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